05-25 第2篇

阅读理解（说明文） How Do Seeds Travel from Place to Place?

① Plants cannot walk. A tall tree that grows for a hundred years will stand in the same corner of a forest all its life. Yet, look around you: dandelions grow in cracks of pavement; apple trees appear in wild fields far from any orchard; coconuts sprout on islands no one has planted. How do new plants reach such places? The answer is hidden in one small traveller — the **seed**.

② The most famous traveller is the **wind-seed**. Think of a dandelion "clock". When you blow it, dozens of tiny parachutes fly away. Each parachute carries one seed. Some go only a few metres; others are lifted by stronger winds and travel for kilometres. Maple seeds also use the wind: they have small wings and spin like helicopters as they fall. Wherever the wind drops them, if soil and water are right, a new plant may begin.

③ Other seeds choose the **water** as their road. The most surprising example is the coconut. Its thick, hairy shell can float on salt water for months without letting the inside seed rot. Ocean currents carry coconuts across seas. When a coconut finally reaches a beach, the waves push it into the warm sand, and a green shoot soon appears. In this way, whole islands can slowly become covered in coconut palms.

④ Many seeds travel by **animals**. Some hide sticky hooks or tiny thorns on their outside. When a dog, a sheep, or even a walking student brushes against the plant, the seeds hold on to fur or clothes. Minutes or hours later, the animal walks far away, and the seeds fall on new soil. Other seeds are sweet and live inside tasty fruits like cherries or berries. A bird eats the fruit, flies across fields, and later drops the hard seeds — already helped with a little fertiliser — in a completely new place.

⑤ A few very clever seeds move themselves. The squirting cucumber, for example, builds up pressure inside its fruit. When the fruit is ripe and someone lightly touches it, it suddenly "shoots" its seeds several metres into the air. This is like a small natural cannon. The touch-me-not plant is another example: when its seed pods dry, they twist and open quickly, flinging the seeds outward.

⑥ Why do plants bother to send their seeds so far? The reason is simple. If all seeds fell straight down under one tree, the young plants would have to fight with the parent tree for light and water. Most of them would not survive. By travelling on wind, water, animals or their own small explosions, seeds find new homes with enough space to grow. Every quiet journey of a seed is, in its own way, part of a long and clever plan to keep green life **spreading across our planet**.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the main topic of the passage?

A. Why plants cannot walk.
B. How seeds travel from place to place.
C. How people grow fruit trees.
D. Why the wind is strong on islands.

2. Which of the following is an example of a wind-seed?

A. A coconut.
B. A cherry.
C. A dandelion.
D. A squirting cucumber.

3. Why can a coconut travel across the sea without the inside seed rotting?

A. Because its thick, hairy shell can float on salt water for months.
B. Because fish push it through the water.
C. Because the sun dries the inside quickly.
D. Because people put it in a bottle.

4. How do some seeds travel on animals?

A. The animal carries them in small bags.
B. The seeds stick to fur or clothes with sticky hooks, or they are eaten inside fruits and later dropped.
C. The animal swallows the whole plant and plants it again.
D. The animal sings to the seeds until they grow.

5. Why is it bad for all seeds to fall straight down under the parent tree?

A. The seeds would be too cold.
B. The young plants would have to fight with the parent tree for light and water, and most would not survive.
C. The wind would blow the tree away.
D. The seeds would be too big to grow.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题

【定位】全文围绕种子的传播方式
【解析】A/C/D 均偏题。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "Think of a dandelion 'clock'... dozens of tiny parachutes..."
【解析】蒲公英靠风传播。A 靠水；B 靠动物；D 靠自身弹射。故选 C。

3.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "Its thick, hairy shell can float on salt water for months without letting the inside seed rot."
【解析】厚壳能浮水并防腐。B/C/D 均无据。故选 A。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "sticky hooks... hold on to fur or clothes... A bird eats the fruit... drops the hard seeds..."
【解析】两种方式：粘附与食用。A/C/D 均不符。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题 / 推理判断题
【定位】第⑥段 "the young plants would have to fight with the parent tree for light and water. Most of them would not survive."
【解析】幼苗抢不过母树。A/C/D 均无据。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **dandelion** [n.] 蒲公英
- **parachute** [n.] 降落伞
- **coconut** [n.] 椰子
- **fertiliser** [n.] 肥料
- **cannon** [n.] 大炮